4.5 BitTyrant

This is a modified version of Azureus version 2.5. The sole difference between these clients is in the way BitTyrant preferentially allocates more upload bandwidth to those peers that send more data to you.

By default, in any BT client, the upload bandwidth is equally distributed among the connected peers. BitTyrant does not limit upload bandwidth; rather, it distributes it in proportion to the download bandwidth available from the peers. For example, if a you're downloading a file from two peers, with one peer sending data at 10 kbps and the other at 20 kbps, BitTyrant will preferentially upload data to the latter peer at twice the rate it uploads to the former. It is claimed that doing so improves the download speeds of swarms by up to 70 per cent!

The interface and configuration options of BitTyrant are similar to those in Azureus (using the Classic interface).

4.6 eMule

4.6.1 Introduction

eMule is an eD2K client—the most popular one.

4.6.2 Usage

When eMule is launched the first time, a wizard guides you through the different steps to configure the system to connect to the network. After the initial configuration, it presents a list of servers. These are the servers that hold information about other peers and the files that they are sharing. To connect to any network, you select it and click the Connect button.

After a server has been connected to, the files shared by the other users in the network can be searched. If the desired file is being shared by anybody, and shows up in the search results, it can be downloaded. The search results can be sorted under different heads like Availability and Complete Sources. It is best to select a copy with more sources in case more than one copy of the file is found.

eMule also implements a serverless network, called Kademlia, shortened to KAD. This is similar in principle to DHT or Peer Exchange in case of the BT protocol. Since it is possible to configure the client